

Golden Thread Textiles — On-Site Audit Report

Facility:	Zirabo Industrial Area, Savar, Dhaka, Bangladesh
Audit type:	SA8000-aligned social compliance audit
Audit dates:	2026-02-02 to 2026-02-04 (3 days)
Auditor:	Meridian Assurance Partners (third-party)
Overall rating:	Conditional — Medium Risk

Executive Summary

This audit of Golden Thread Textiles' Savar facility identified several non-conformances requiring corrective action. None were assessed as an immediate threat to life, but the excessive-overtime and fire-alarm findings below require verified remediation within the stated deadlines or the facility's rating will be downgraded at follow-up.

Labor Practices

Worker interviews (42 workers sampled across three shifts) and timekeeping records for the peak production period (August-October 2025) showed average weekly hours of 68, exceeding the 60-hour legal maximum including overtime. Base wages matched the legally mandated minimum wage in all sampled records, but overtime premium pay for temporary/contract workers was calculated at the standard hourly rate rather than the required 1.5x premium in 11 of 30 sampled pay slips.

Health & Safety

Two emergency exits on the Building B sewing floor were found obstructed by stacked fabric rolls at the start of the audit; both were cleared before the auditors left the floor. Facility records show the fire alarm and detection system was last tested 14 months ago, exceeding the facility's own stated 12-month testing interval.

Grievance Mechanism

A worker grievance hotline and suggestion-box system exists per facility policy documents. However, of the 42 workers interviewed, only 9 were aware the mechanism existed, and several expressed distrust that complaints would be handled without retaliation.

Corrective Action Log

Finding	Severity	Due Date	Status
Excessive weekly overtime (68 hrs vs 60 hr legal max)	Major	60 days	Open
Overtime premium miscalculated for temp workers	Major	30 days	Open
Fire alarm system testing overdue	Major	Immediate	Open
Low worker awareness of grievance mechanism	Minor	90 days	Open

Conclusion

Recommendation: conditional pass. A follow-up audit is scheduled for 2026-05-04 (90 days) to verify closure of all open corrective actions. Certification will be suspended if the overtime and fire-alarm findings are not verifiably remediated.